

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

This article appeared in an online newspaper:

Tourism Management

Tourism is growing fast globally. To manage the impact of tourism on the environment, culture and local way of life, popular travel destinations have developed their own strategies:

A tax on tourists

Venice, the beautiful city in Italy, was built on water and has been dealing with problems caused by tourists for a long time. In 2019, Venice started to impose a tax of €10 on each visitor to pay for the maintenance of the city and the repair works made necessary by the large number of tourists.

Locals first

In Amsterdam, the Netherlands, the government wants to prioritise the needs of the 1 million locals before those of the tourists. Developments of new hotels and tourist attractions have all been stopped. Tourists are also constantly reminded of the importance of respecting the locals through city-wide campaigns, advertisements and signs.

Timed entry tickets

Since July 2017, tourists have been required to book a time to visit the ruins of the ancient city of Machu Picchu, Peru. Booking of tickets sometimes has to be made months in advance. Entry tickets are either valid from 6:00am to 12:00pm or from 12:00pm to 5:30pm.

A total ban

Since October 2019, all travellers have officially been banned from climbing Uluru, a natural wonder considered sacred by native Australians. Previously, many climbers were told to leave for disrespecting the environmental and spiritual significance of the site.

Your group is doing a project on the impact of tourism in different parts of the world. You may want to talk about:

- benefits tourism can bring to a city
- problems tourism can bring to a city
- whether Hong Kong should follow any of the above management strategies
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. What do tourists like to do in Hong Kong?
2. What can people learn from visiting another country?
3. What makes Hong Kong a good place to visit?
4. Would you like to work in the tourism industry?
5. Is it better to plan your own trip or join a tour?
6. Do you prefer to travel alone or with friends and family?
7. Why do so many people travel these days?
8. How can you be a responsible tourist?